

Taiwan Non-Tech Sector

UBS Taiwan Summit 2026 key takeaways: affirm bike recovery, AI capacity crunch lifts EPC

Equities

Taiwan

Consumer, Cyclical

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UBS Taiwan Summit 2026: Non-tech day tour on 17 Sept

We hosted a post conference day tour, inviting Makalot, PCSC, Giant, TECO (1504 TT, not rated) and CTCI (9933 TT, not rated). **Giant** highlighted e-bikes as a key revenue driver in Europe and a recovery in China's premium road bikes. **Makalot** could benefit from its ability to fulfill urgent, short-lead-time orders at higher margins, supporting gross margin expansion in H226 and an order volume inflection in 2027. **PCSC** is monetising its digital infrastructure through broader Open Point adoption and consumption data services. In industrials, **CTCI's** elevated contract wins and backlog underpin multi-year revenue visibility across power, water and petrochemical projects. **TECO** added structural growth exposure to power and energy infrastructure, Southeast Asian data centers and modular data center (MDC) solutions.

Consumer: Bikes and apparel set for 2027 rebound

Giant views e-bikes as a key growth driver in Europe and the US in 2027. Giant is not concerned about recent defaults by European bike companies causing another inventory destocking issue, as consumers prefer new models over old ones. Giant is also positive about a high-end road bike demand recovery in China in 2027. **Makalot** highlighted brand customers are utilizing AI technology to control procurement costs and manage inventory through conservative and short-lead-time order placement. These have raised challenges for manufacturers. Makalot has strength in manufacturing urgent orders at higher margins. As such, Makalot's management thinks its gross margin could expand in H226. Also, Makalot expects an inflection point, with order volume resuming growth in 2027. **PCSC** expects a favourable sales mix change to drive gross margin expansion. It also expects expanding Open Point usage and solid growth in consumption data analysis services to serve as returns on its recent digital infrastructure investment.

Industrial: Growth fuelled by higher backlog visibility and data center demand

CTCI is an integrated engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) name and provides turnkey solutions. Management highlighted the new contracts it has signed have stayed at a high level of over NT\$100bn during the past four years. Its order backlog is at a historical high of NT\$490bn, which could turn into revenue in the next couple of years. These contracts include power plant construction (eg, TaiPower LNG projects), reclaimed water systems for factories (eg, TSMC Tainan Science Park) and oil/petrochemical/refinery facilities. **TECO** offers equipment and provides construction services for mechanical, electrical and plumbing (MEP) functions. TECO highlighted its power and energy sector has the highest growth among its major businesses. TECO has projects on hand to build data centers for CSPs in Southeast Asia and expects its MDC products to complete a proof of concept (POC) demonstration in Q426.

Stock picks: Buy Giant and Makalot

We maintain our positive outlook on a cyclical demand recovery and an operating margin recovery for the bike sector in 2027. Giant is our most-preferred stock. We also rate Makalot Buy, on margin expansion and a 7% dividend yield. We rate PCSC Neutral, on stable top-line growth, with limited OPM expansion on continued store expansion and logistic center investment.

SUMMIT NOTES

Giant (9921.TW, Buy)

- **E-bikes to be a major growth driver in 2027:** Giant has seen e-bikes return to growth in the US and Europe YTD in 2026. This has been driven by Giant's new products targeting commuting markets. Giant expects commuting demand to continue driving e-bike growth at 10-15% in 2027.
- **Positive demand outlook in major markets:** Giant is not concerned about recent defaults by European bike companies causing another inventory destocking issue, as consumers prefer new models over old ones. For China, Giant expects high-end road bikes to recover in 2027. In the US, gravel bikes and e-bikes are selling well. On the withhold release order ([WRO](#)), Giant has submitted documents and is awaiting approval.
- **Management expects a gross margin recovery and opex uncertainty:** Giant expects gross margin to expand further in 2027, as higher utilization and no price discounts for inventory destocking offset an unfavourable sales mix, with higher OE sales. However, Giant is conservative on opex due to ongoing legal counsel expenses for the WRO, freight, etc.

Makalot (1477.TW, Buy)

- **Selective order intake:** In Q426, Makalot expects volume to increase in the low-single digits YoY and ASP to increase 5-7%, reflecting higher material costs, favourable product mix changes and urgent orders. It expects GM to expand QoQ, as Makalot selectively takes orders with better margins. For 2027, management expects an inflection point and single-digit volume growth, with additional 3-4% upside if the negative impact of Middle East tension on consumption sentiment eases.
- **Margin expansion on increasing urgent orders:** Makalot sees brand customers relying more on rush orders for improved inventory management. Makalot highlighted strength in gaining rush orders with good factory locations and workers capable of multi-tasking. As such, Makalot's margins for urgent orders are higher than for general ones. Makalot expects its gross margin to expand as urgent orders take up a higher portion of the sales mix: 10% of sales in Q425 but up to 12% in Q126 and 15% in Q326, while management expects 15-20% in Q426. Brands have been utilizing AI tech on data analysis to lower procurement costs. Management believes price pressure has largely passed.

PCSC (2912.TW, Neutral)

- **Rising opportunities for higher 7-11 store penetration in Taiwan:** It is seeing competitors, such as HiLife, turning more aggressive in adding new stores. With tech companies expanding into new areas, PCSC sees potential to add more new stores into these new areas. Management indicated that it would customize new stores to meet the requirements of each market, rather than focusing on larger store formats.
- **Further OPM expansion constrained:** Despite steady growth supported by new store additions, 7-11 Taiwan's OPM improvement is likely to remain constrained by ongoing store openings and higher depreciation related to a logistics-center build-out. Meanwhile, it views wider Open Point adoption and solid growth of consumption data analysis service fees as good monetization of its digital infrastructure investment.
- **Taiwan government's NT\$10k cash distribution to drive per-store-daily sales (PSD):** Management expects Taiwan's NT\$10k cash distribution, beginning in early 2027, to support PSD growth for its retail stores, aided by a related marketing campaign. It does not foresee significant pressure on associated opex.

TECO (1504.TW, not rated)

- **Sales driven by motor and data center businesses; margins improving:** Teco expects 2026 sales to grow in the low to mid-teens YoY, driven by its power and energy and green mechatronics sector. It thinks margins could continue to improve on a better product mix across green mechatronics (more customized large motors), power and energy (increased data center equipment) and HVAC technology (discontinuing low-gross-margin home appliance business), along with disciplined opex control (lower R&D cost as a percentage of sales going forward).
- **NT\$10bn data center contract award target for 2026:** Teco is upbeat about its data center business. Teco has been working with major CSPs and was awarded NT\$7bn in data center contracts YTD. Teco expects data center equipment (higher gross margin vs. data center construction) to account for 30% of its data center segment in 2026. Its MDC products could complete proof-of-concept by Q4'26, as per management.

CTCI (9933.TW, not rated)

- **Sales returning to an upward trajectory as of 2027, with stable margins:** CTCI mentioned that it was awarded NT\$84bn in orders as of July 2026, with the order backlog reaching NT\$490bn as of June 2026. It foresees stronger sales growth in 2027 and a record-high in 2028, as most of its projects enter the construction phase. It also expects the gross margin and opex/sales ratio to stay stable at the H126 level.
- **Significant opportunities around the high-tech sector and ESG:** It sees significant opportunities in gas-fired power plants (NT\$300bn market opportunity), LNG receiving terminals (NT\$420bn), water resources (NT\$150bn) and waste processing facilities, along with petro-chem facilities in the Middle East (NT\$500bn). High-tech is another field CTCI is tapping into. Additionally, CTCI partners with key component suppliers to mitigate component shortage issues and utilizes foreign workers to weather labour shortages in Taiwan.

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Key risks for the sportswear sector are: 1) a slowdown in economic growth, which would dampen sportswear end-demand; 2) changes in consumer preferences from sportswear to other categories; 3) order losses from global brands; 4) rising labour costs; and 5) operating risks from managing multinational plants.

Key risks for the bicycle sector are: 1) a global economic slowdown impacting end-user demand; 2) a shortage of components; 3) FX risk; 4) a rise in raw material prices; 5) unfavourable weather; and 6) lower-than-expected popularity of e-bike products.

Key risks for the industrial sector are: 1) unexpected changes in the underlying global macro environment; 2) currency and interest rate movement; and 3) commodity price inflation.

Key risks for the consumer sector are: 1) slower-than-expected economic growth; 2) weaker-than-expected private consumption, driven by deteriorating unemployment; and 3) a potentially inflationary environment.

We base our price target for Giant on a PE multiple. The key downside risks are: 1) a global economic slowdown impacting end-user demand; 2) foreign exchange risk; 3) a rise in raw material prices; 4) unfavourable weather; and 5) lower-than-expected popularity of e-bike products.

We base our price target for Makalot on a DCF methodology. Downside risks to our investment thesis include: 1) weaker-than-expected casual-wear demand; 2) weaker-than-expected market share gains over China-based manufacturers; and 3) unfavourable FX movements.

We base our price target for PCSC on a PE multiple. Key upside risks include: 1) higher-than-expected PSD growth at 7-Eleven Taiwan; 2) a faster and stronger pick-up in PCSC's online business in the Taiwan market; and 3) a higher-than-expected operating margin at 7-Eleven Taiwan due to positive operating leverage. Key downside risks include: 1) lower-than-expected PSD growth at 7-Eleven Taiwan; 2) slower- and weaker-than-expected online business development; and 3) lower-than-expected operating margin at 7-Eleven Taiwan due to more aggressive marketing campaigns and negative operating leverage.

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Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

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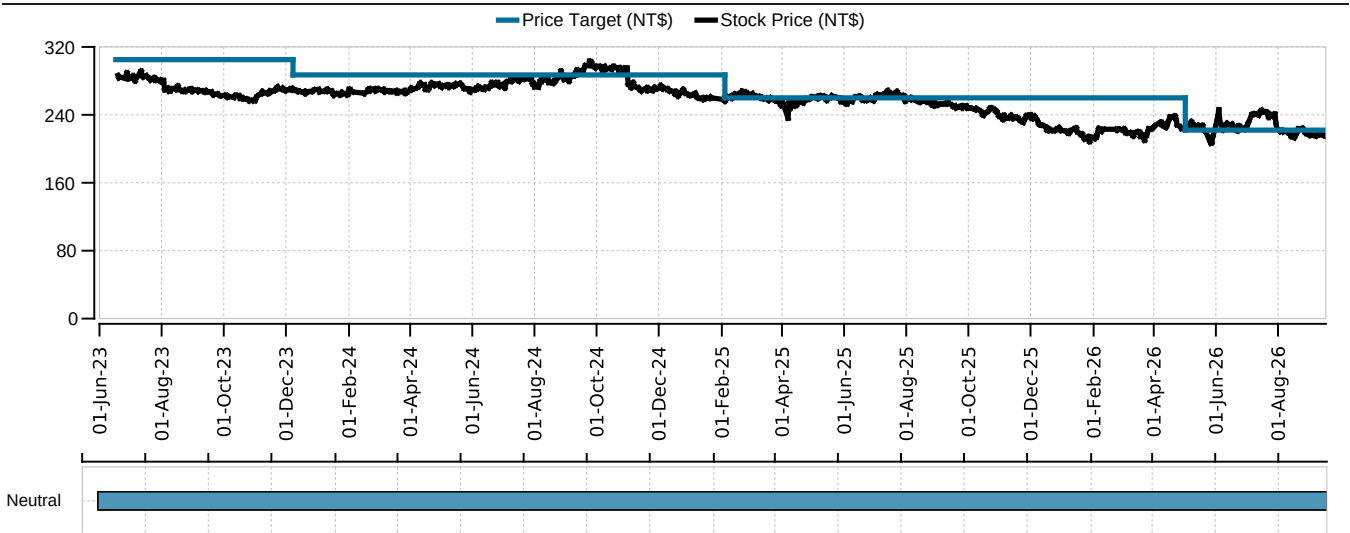
Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Giant Manufacturing	9921.TW	Buy	NT\$90.00	17 Sep 2026
Makalot Industrial	1477.TW	Buy	NT\$194.00	17 Sep 2026
President Chain Store ²⁸	2912.TW	Neutral	NT\$217.50	17 Sep 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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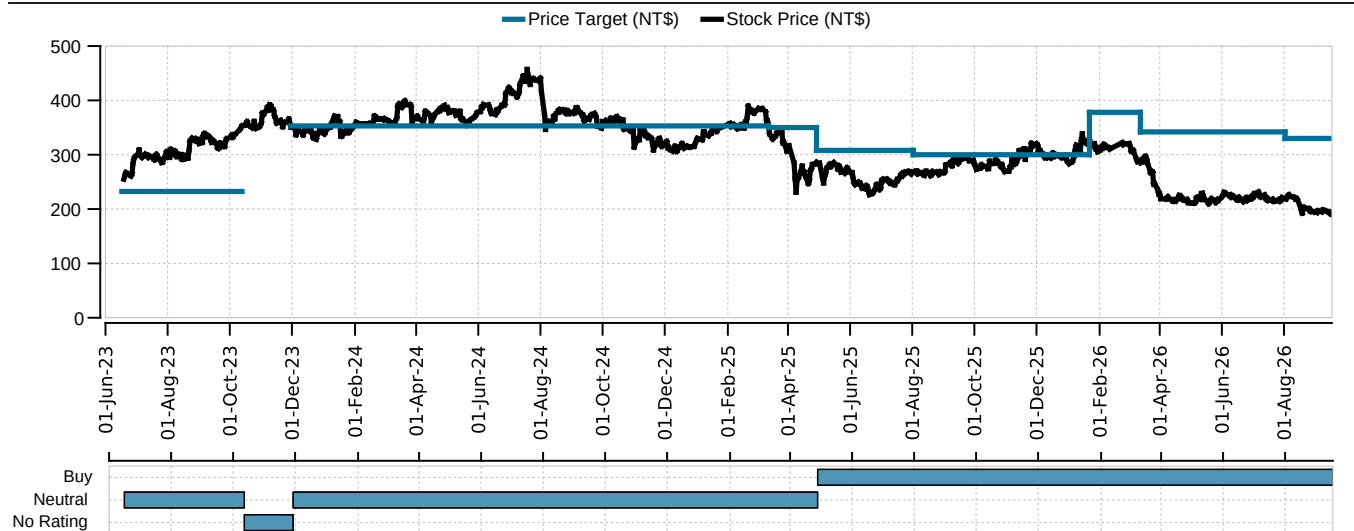
President Chain Store (NT\$)



Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2023-06-16	284.50	305.00	Neutral
2023-12-07	269.50	287.00	Neutral
2025-02-03	258.00	260.00	Neutral
2026-05-01	224.00	222.00	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 17-Sep-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

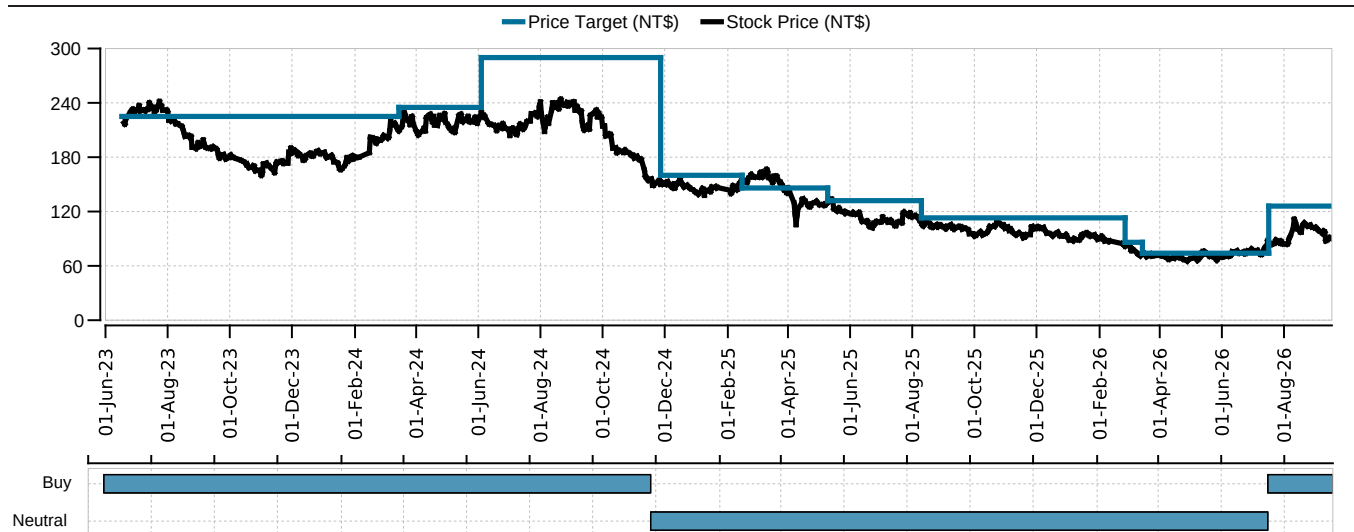
Makalot Industrial (NT\$)



Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2023-06-16	258.82	232.353	Neutral
2023-10-12	350.00	-	No Rating
2023-11-29	357.84	353.00	Neutral
2025-03-12	362.00	350.00	Neutral
2025-04-28	283.50	308.00	Buy
2025-08-01	267.50	300.00	Buy
2026-01-21	323.50	378.00	Buy
2026-03-12	289.00	342.00	Buy
2026-08-01	219.50	330.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 17-Sep-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Giant Manufacturing (NT\$)



Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2023-06-16	217.50	225.00	Buy
2024-03-14	211.00	235.00	Buy
2024-06-03	225.00	290.00	Buy
2024-11-26	155.00	160.00	Neutral
2025-02-14	154.00	146.00	Neutral
2025-05-09	128.50	132.00	Neutral
2025-08-09	110.50	113.00	Neutral

Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2026-02-25	82.60	86.00	Neutral
2026-03-14	71.00	74.00	Neutral
2026-07-16	88.00	126.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 17-Sep-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Additional Prices: Teco Electric and Machinery, NT\$70.90 (17 Sep 2026); CTCL Corporation, NT\$42.4 (17 Sep 2026); Source: UBS. All prices as of local market close.

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